



L-Fit Pathways

Bootle · Liverpool · Sefton

Commissioner Information Pack

Safeguarding-led alternative provision for young
people aged 5–25, across Bootle, Liverpool & Sefton

For schools, colleges & local authority commissioners

15-17 Irlam Road, Bootle, Liverpool, L20 4AE

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About L-Fit Pathways

“We believe every young person deserves a pathway — no matter where they are starting from.”

Founded by co-directors Adam Byrne and Craig Lloyd, L-Fit Pathways is an alternative provision based in Bootle, Liverpool. We support young people aged 5 to 25 who have not yet found the right environment to thrive — offering structured, compassionate, experience-based learning with safeguarding at the centre of everything we do.

- Trauma-informed, relationship-based practice at our core
- KCSIE 2026 compliant — full safeguarding and SEND policies in place
- One-to-one and small-group delivery tailored to each individual
- Structured reintegration pathways back into education or training
- Deep community roots across Bootle, Sefton and Liverpool
- Supporting young people at risk of becoming NEET

Our Operating Model

L-Fit Pathways operates as an **unregistered alternative provision**, delivering fewer than 18 hours of provision per week to each young person, in line with Department for Education thresholds for unregistered settings. Above this threshold, a setting is required to register as an independent school with Ofsted — we structure our provision to operate transparently within the unregistered model, and welcome scrutiny from commissioning schools and local authorities on this at any time. We also monitor the DfE's developing National Standards for Alternative Provision and are committed to meeting them as they are formalised.

Our Core Provisions

Animal Assisted Learning

Delivered in partnership with an outsourced, licensed Animal Assisted Learning provider. Builds empathy, emotional regulation and a sense of responsibility in a calm, therapeutic setting — particularly effective for SEMH needs, anxiety and trauma histories.

Forest School

Outdoor learning in a natural setting following recognised Forest School principles: learner-led exploration, achievable risk, and regular contact with the same outdoor space. Builds problem-solving, teamwork, independence and resilience away from the classroom.

Educational Tuition

One-to-one and small-group tuition across core subjects (English, Maths, Science), working to school/college targets, individual learning plans and EHCPs.

Boxing Fitness & Discipline

Non-contact boxing training providing structure, discipline and a healthy physical outlet — improving focus, respect and self-esteem.

Life Skills

Practical sessions covering communication, budgeting, cooking, personal safety, travel training and independence — preparation for young people transitioning to adulthood or at risk of NEET.

Reintegration & Transition

Structured support for young people working toward returning to mainstream/alternative education, progressing to college, or moving into employment, with progress reporting and a personalised transition plan.

Who We Support

We work with young people from 5 to 25 across a broad range of need — whether they are excluded, home-educated, at risk of becoming NEET, or simply struggling to engage in their current setting.

Age Groups & Key Stages

Stage	Ages	Focus
KS1	Ages 5–7	Nurture-based early intervention for young children struggling to settle.
KS2	Ages 7–11	Structured support alongside or instead of primary schooling.
KS3	Ages 11–14	Engagement programmes and emotional support through secondary entry.
KS4	Ages 14–16	Tuition aligned to GCSE targets alongside therapeutic provision.
KS5	Ages 16–19	Alternative to or alongside college, vocational readiness and progression.
NEET	Ages 16–25	Life skills, employment readiness and structured re-engagement pathways.

Presenting Needs We Support

School Refusal & EBSA. Emotionally-based school avoidance addressed through gradual, therapeutic re-engagement at the young person's own pace.

Exclusion (Fixed Term or Permanent). Responsive alternative provision during exclusion periods with structured reintegration planning from day one.

SEND & Complex Needs. Experience across ADHD, autism, trauma, attachment difficulties, learning differences and SEMH needs.

Elective Home Education (EHE). Supplementary or full provision for home-educated young people, including PE, socialisation and tuition.

EOTAS & EHCP Placements. Education Other Than At School and EHCP-funded placements with progress reporting and review attendance.

NEET & Post-16 Disengagement. Young people aged 16–25 who are not in education, employment or training and need a structured pathway forward.

Safeguarding & Compliance

Safeguarding is the foundation every session, referral and record at L-Fit Pathways is built on.

Safeguarding Leadership

Adam Byrne	Co-Director & Designated Safeguarding Lead. Level 5 Safeguarding/DSL trained. Enhanced DBS checked.
Craig Lloyd	Co-Director & Designated Safeguarding Lead. Level 5 Safeguarding/DSL trained. Enhanced DBS checked.

Both co-directors hold joint Designated Safeguarding Lead responsibility, meaning a trained DSL is always contactable during provision hours. All staff and volunteers working directly with young people are subject to Enhanced DBS checks in line with our Safer Recruitment Policy.

Forest School tool-use and fire-lighting sessions: neither co-director currently holds a recognised Forest School leader qualification. Our published Risk Assessment and Forest School provision pages reflect this honestly — tool-based and fire-lighting activity will only be introduced once led by a staff member holding that qualification. All other Forest School activity (shelter-building, nature-based teamwork) proceeds as normal.

Statutory & Legislative Framework

- Keeping Children Safe in Education (KCSIE) 2026
- Working Together to Safeguard Children (2026)
- Children Act 1989 & Children Act 2004
- Education Act 1996, Section 19 (EOTAS)
- Arranging Alternative Provision — DfE Guidance for Local Authorities & Schools
- SEND Code of Practice 2015 (0–25 years)
- Equality Act 2010
- UK GDPR & Data Protection Act 2018
- Health and Safety at Work etc. Act 1974
- The Prevent Duty (Counter-Terrorism and Security Act 2015)

A Question About Our Compliance?

If you are a school, college or local authority commissioner and would like to discuss our safeguarding practice, policies or registration status in more detail before making a referral, we welcome that conversation.

Policies We Hold

All 17 policies below have been formally adopted by our co-directors and are reviewed annually. Full PDFs are available to download at lfitpathways.com/policies-documents/ or on request.

Policy	Covers
Safeguarding & Child Protection Policy	How we identify and respond to welfare concerns, referral procedures, and the role of our two DSLs.
Safer Recruitment & DBS Policy	Enhanced DBS checks, identity verification and reference checks for all staff and volunteers.
Health & Safety Policy	First aid, fire safety, insurance and day-to-day health & safety of every session.
Data Protection Policy	How personal data on young people, families and staff is collected, used, stored and protected (UK GDPR).
Risk Assessment	Activity-specific hazard, control and review record covering premises and off-site sessions.
Behaviour Management Policy	A trauma-informed, relationship-based approach to behaviour.
Complaints Policy	How parents, schools, colleges or local authorities can raise a concern, and how we respond.
Equality, Diversity & Accessibility Policy	Equal treatment and accessible provision for every young person, regardless of background or need.
Online Safety & Acceptable Use Policy	Device use, filtering and our response to online safety incidents.
Educational Visits & Off-Site Activities Policy	Planning, risk-assessing and approving off-site activities, including Forest School.
Animal Welfare Policy	Standards for the welfare of animals involved in Animal Assisted Learning sessions.
Staff Code of Conduct	Professional standards expected of everyone who works at or with L-Fit Pathways.
Whistleblowing Policy	How staff can raise concerns about conduct or practice, in confidence.
Anti-Bullying Policy	How we define, prevent and respond to bullying in all its forms.
Attendance & Registration Policy	How we record and report attendance to referring schools, colleges and local authorities.
Supporting Young People with Medical Conditions Policy	How we support young people with ongoing medical needs during sessions.
Lone Working Policy	Procedures for staff who may, in specific circumstances, work alone with a young person.

Meet the Team

L-Fit Pathways is led day-to-day by our two co-directors, who are also our joint Designated Safeguarding Leads. Every session, referral and record runs under their direct oversight.

Adam Byrne — Co-Director & Designated Safeguarding Lead

Co-founded L-Fit Pathways to give young people who haven't yet found the right environment a structured, compassionate way back into learning. Level 5 Safeguarding/DSL trained and Enhanced DBS checked.

Craig Lloyd — Co-Director & Designated Safeguarding Lead

Co-founded L-Fit Pathways alongside Adam, sharing joint responsibility for safeguarding across every provision. Level 5 Safeguarding/DSL trained and Enhanced DBS checked.

As L-Fit Pathways grows, mentors and tutors delivering our provisions will be added here. Every member of the team who works directly with young people holds an Enhanced DBS check and is trained in line with our Safeguarding & Child Protection Policy.

Our Location

15-17 Irlam Road, Bootle, Liverpool, L20 4AE — easily reached from across Sefton and North Liverpool, with good transport links for schools, colleges and families arranging drop-off or transport. Open Monday–Friday, 8:30am–5:00pm.

Referral Process

1. Submit a Referral — Parents, schools, colleges or professionals can all refer via lfitpathways.com or by phone/email. We respond within 2 working days.

2. Initial Meeting — A no-pressure initial meeting to understand the young person's needs, strengths, goals and current situation.

3. Personalised Plan — A tailored provision plan co-produced with the young person, their family and any involved professionals or LA contacts.

4. Active Provision — Provision begins with regular progress reviews, written reports and a clear forward pathway.

Fees & Funding

Provision is commissioned on a per-referral basis, tailored to the young person's needs and the number of sessions/hours required, and can be funded via school AP budgets, local authority commissioning, or EHCP top-up funding. Specific day/session rates are agreed directly with the referring school, college or local authority as part of the initial meeting — please contact us to discuss current rates for your referral.

Fee schedule to be confirmed directly by L-Fit Pathways — this pack intentionally does not state specific figures so commissioners always receive current, accurate rates.

Get in Touch

Address	15-17 Irlam Road, Bootle, Liverpool, L20 4AE
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Phone	07944 308462
Email	adam.byrne@lfitpathways.com
Website	lfitpathways.com
Referrals	lfitpathways.com — Make a Referral (responds within 2 working days)